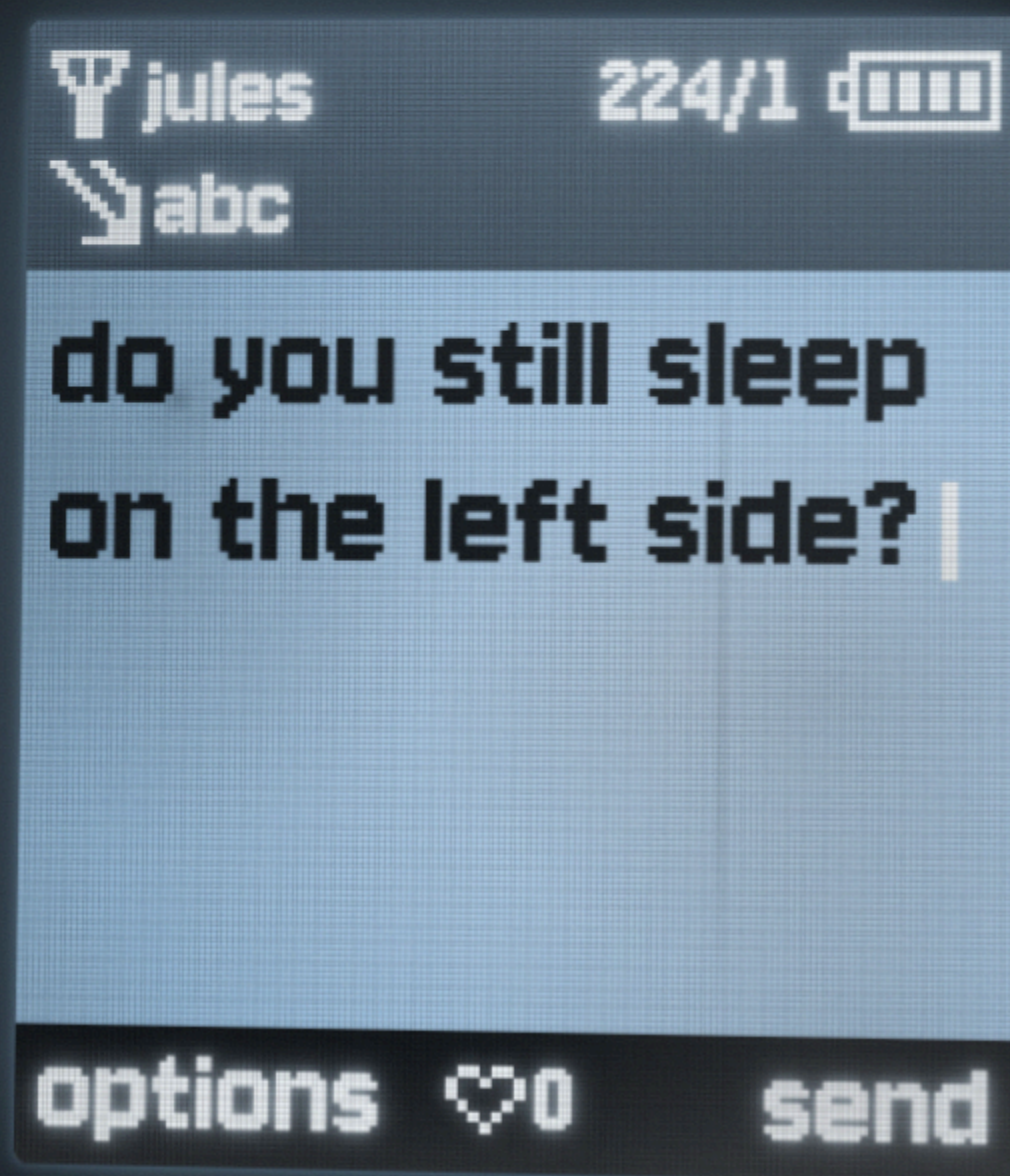
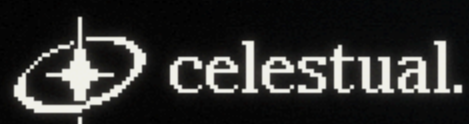


how to build a product where *nothing* happens.

a founder's notes on
building celestial.



lesson 1 the mechanic



you send a
note privately.

they never know.

unless they send
you one back.

then it's mutual.

fig. 2

the story the product tells, in four frames.

lesson 2 silence

silence is the product working.

if it's ever mutual, you'll both know. if it isn't, nobody ever will.

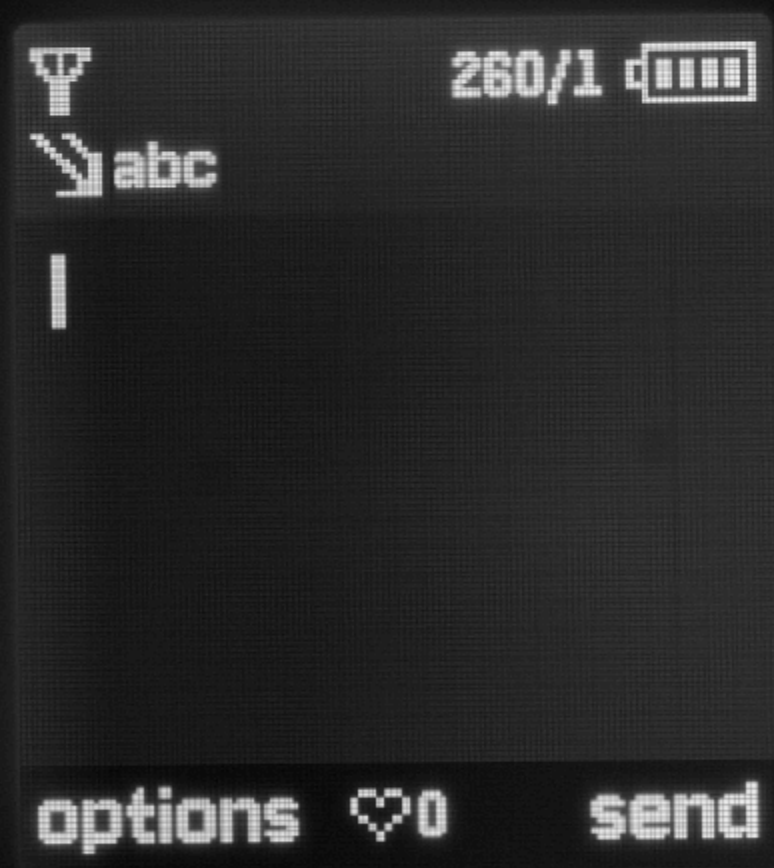
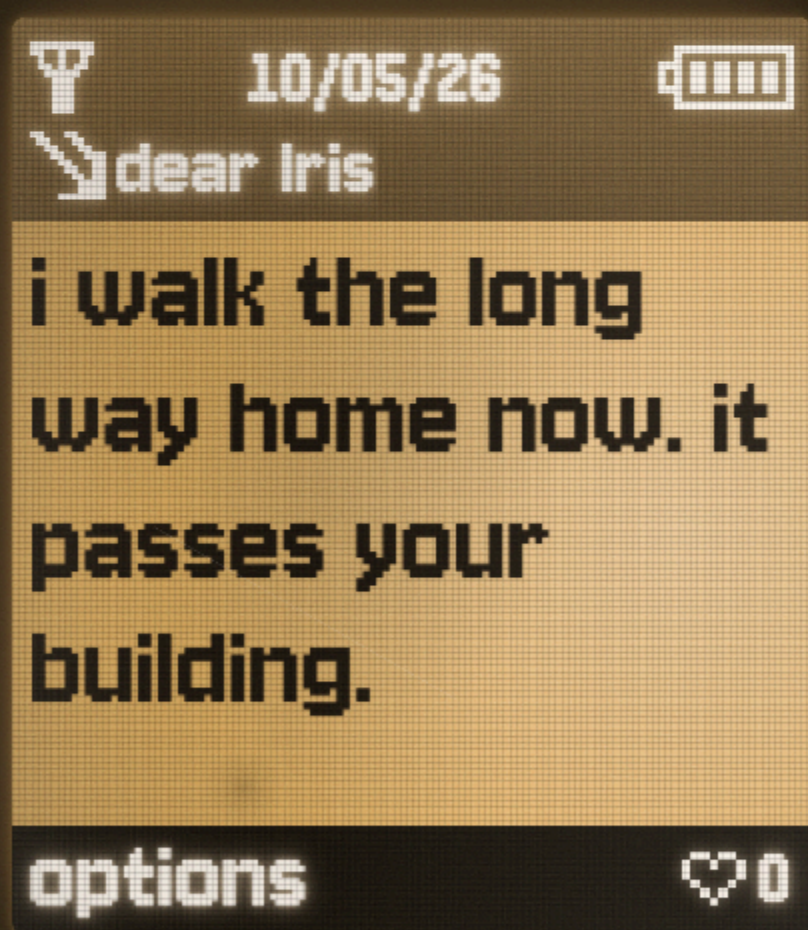


fig. 3 the cursor is still blinking.

lesson 3 counts

truth, exactly.

every count is exactly true, or it isn't
there. no implied activity, no padded
numbers, no hint that someone likes you.



the battery

the writer's to set. it
counts nothing, so it
claims nothing.

nobody has hearted it, so
it says 0.

the heart

fig. 4 a letter on the wall, as it stands.

lesson 4 words

our copy has a linter.

no exclamation marks. no emoji. no dashes.

a script reads every word the product says, the mails included, and fails on any of the three.



**not this time.
they didn't send
you one. they'll
never know you
did.**

ok

*a dash is a writer
stalling. use a
full stop, or cut
the second half.*

celestial's voice guide

fig. 5 a night that was not mutual. it passes.

lesson 5 light

one bright thing per screen.

a lit surface or a bloom. never both, and never two of either. the eye has to land somewhere.

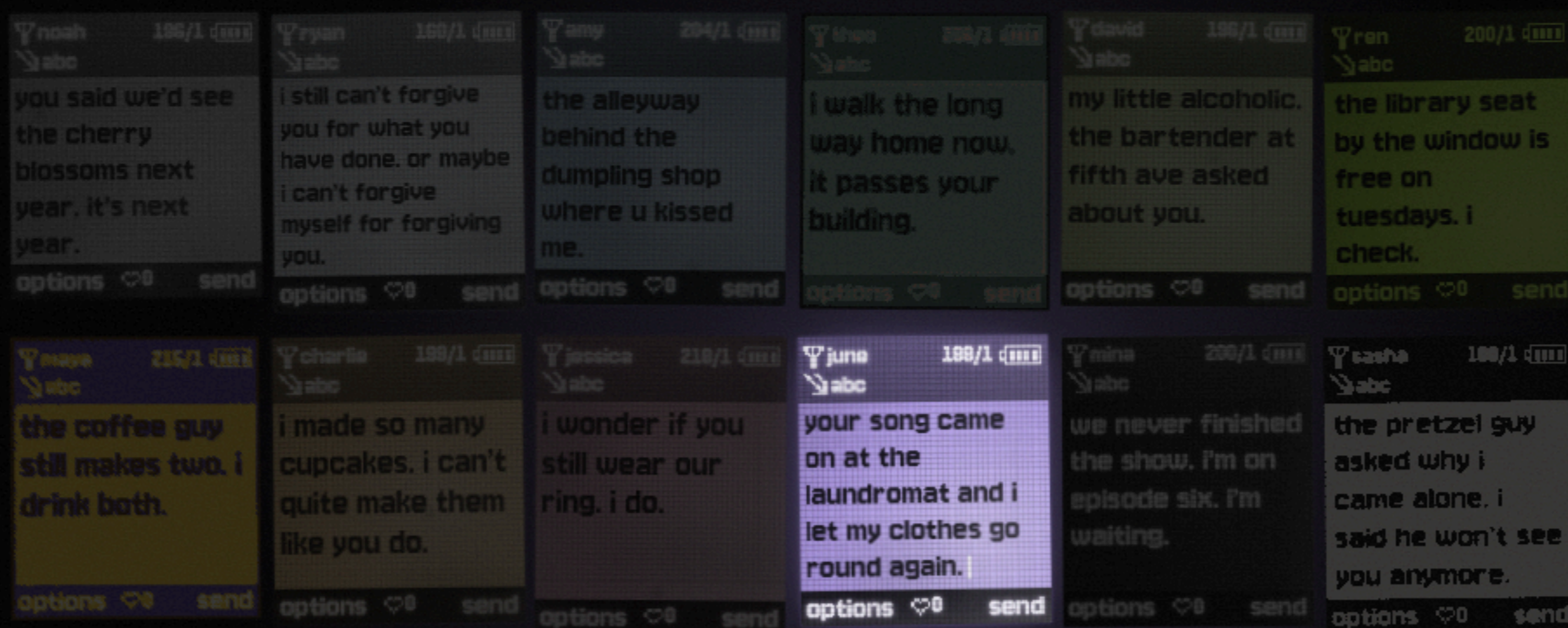
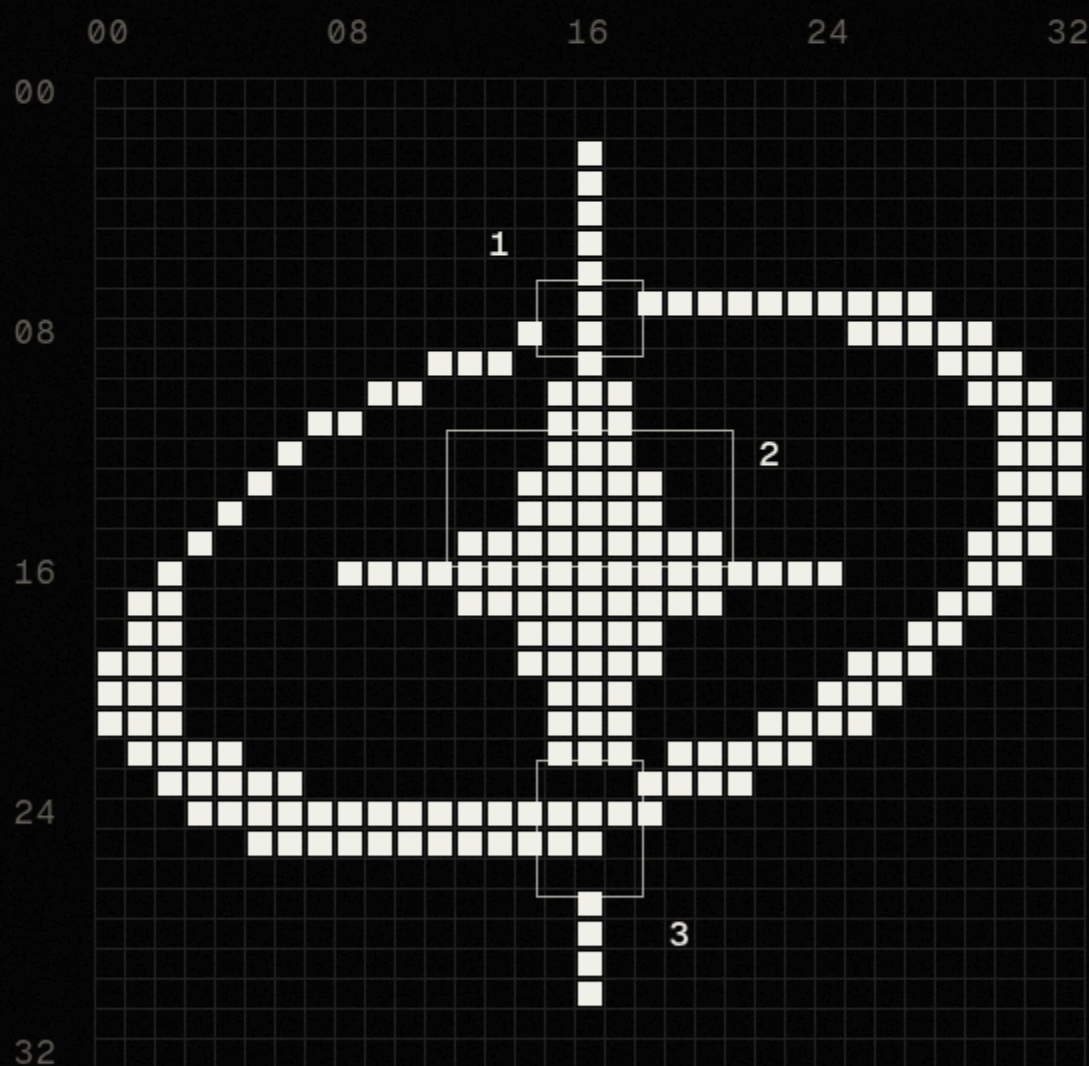


fig. 6 twelve colours, and one of them on.

lesson 6 drawn

everything is drawn.

no icon set, no stock, no bitmap. the grain is feTurbulence. the mark is 33 by 33 cells, rastered from nine constants, then every cell looked at.



1 behind

the ring stops a cell short of the needle.

2 the star

a cell narrower each row, so it reads as a sparkle.

3 in front

the needle stops a cell short of the ring.

fig. 7 the mark, a cell at a time.



nothing happens
unless it's mutual.

